that is, before Columbus' expedition. But non-Latin American societies, which have experienced pre-European forms of colonising aggression, such as Middle Eastern colonialism, have the right to identify their own respective 'cut-off' periods to define indigeneity. This is consistent with decoloniality's rejection of formulation of abstract universals, and commitment to contextuality. Therefore, every society has the right to identify and define coloniality and decoloniality based on its own unique history and experience.

## The Relational Land Ontology of Indigeneity

Having said the above, the next issue that needs to be addressed is the relationship between indigeneity and nature, given the paradigm shift triggered by coloniality's approach to nature. From the perspective of the Christian European coloniser, the forced transaction with indigenous peoples that took the shape of colonisation was only incidental to his true objective—the acquisition of territory for the imposition of his worldview and subjugation through conversion or elimination of those who stood in the way. The coloniser had no use for indigenous peoples because they were impediments to his divine right and duty to establish his dominion over any non-Christian territory. The only divine purpose fulfilled by the indigenous peoples was to present the coloniser with the opportunity to fulfil his evangelical obligations. In other words, the relationship between coloniality and nature/land/geography was one of ownership for the purposes of enjoyment, which is the product of its dualist undergirding and the specific Christian OET behind humanism.

In contrast to the proprietorial approach of coloniality, indigeneity's attitude to land/nature is based on 'relationality'.[35] The use of relationality here is different from its use earlier in the context of facilitating intercultural communication. Here, relationality means seeing humans as being part of nature and not outside of it. This translates to obligations towards nature, including 'reciprocal obligations between humans and the other-than-human'. Such relationality not only informs the relationship between indigenous communities and nature, it also shapes their epistemologies and faiths as we saw earlier.[36] Specific rituals and traditions are evolved that give primacy to the geography and elevate the relationship to a sacred status, a relationship that people of Bharat can relate to. Such an